

SUFFRAGISTS take action

WOMEN WIN THE VOTE

Women in New Zealand (see pp. 138–142) had won the right to vote in 1893, but the rest of the world proved slow to follow, despite the campaigning of suffragist groups. In the UK, one such group was the National Union of Women's Suffrage Societies (NUWSS), founded in 1897 under the leadership of Millicent Fawcett. She was a suffragist who believed in peaceful campaigning, as only then would women be seen as intelligent and responsible enough to participate in politics.

However, progress was slow and frustrations grew. The suffragists continued their work, but another, more militant kind of activism soon came to overshadow their contributions.

In Finland, women won the right to vote in 1906 as part of a socialist uprising against the Czarist regime, which they pressured with demonstrations and threats of a general strike. As the journal *Palvelijatarlehti* declared, it was not time for compromises. A British group known as the Suffragettes took a similarly

